taken on a large scale. This resulted in sharp decline in death rate to 15 per thousand, but the birth rate did not fall at the same pace. It fell from 40 to 37 per thousand and this led to population explosion during this period. A steep rise in population growth rate (over 2 per cent) was due to a steep fall in the mortality rate accompanied by high fertility rate.

Table 3.1: Growth of Population in India (1891-2008)

Census Year	Populations in millions	Increase or Decrease (in millions)	Percentage Increase or Decrease
1891	236		
1901	236	0.0	0.0
1911	252	+16	+5.7
1921	251	-1	-0.3
(1891-1921)		**+15**	**+0.19**
1931	279	+28	+11.0
1941	319	+40	+14.2
1951	361	+42	+13.3
(1921-1951)		**+110**	**+1.22**
1961	439	+78	+21.6
1971	548	+109	+24.8
1981	683	+135	+24.7
(1951-1981)		**+322**	**+2.14**
1991	846	+161	+23.9
2001	1029	+183	+21.5
2011	1210	+181	+17.64
(1981-2011)			

Source: Census of India 2001, Series 1, Paper 1 of 2001, Provisional Population Totals, Economic Survey, 2009-10, Census 2011 (Provisional Population Totals)

Phase IV: 1981-2011 (High growth with definite signs of slowing down)

India entered the fourth phase of demographic transition marked by high population growth with definite sign of slowing down. Total population increased from 683 million in 1981 to 1210 million in 2011 indicating an increase of 77.2 per cent during the 30 year period. The compound annual growth rate of population reduced from 2.14 per cent (1991-2001) to 1.64 per cent (2001-2011). Most Indian states such as Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, West Bengal, Punjab, Himachal Pradesh, Gujarat and Assam have recorded low birth rates during this phase. States like Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar and Rajasthan will take some more years for complete implementation of family planning programme.

Table 3.2: Compound annual Growth Rate of Population

Year	Growth Rate
1891-1921	0.19
1921-1951	1.22
1951-1981	2.15
1981-2001	1.93
2001-2011	1.64

Source: Census of India 2001

Although the results from the Census 2021 have been delayed due to COVID 19, there are indications that India is moving faster than earlier projected towards attaining replacement level fertility rates at the state level and the consequent stabilisation of population. Recent surveys show that in majority of Indian states fertility rate has fallen well below the replacement level of 2.1 and the country is fast approaching the replacement level itself. The total fertility rate of India stands at 2.2 as of 2017.

3.3.2 Birth Rates and Death Rates

The rate of growth of population depends on birth rate and death rate. The difference between birth rate and death rate gives us acceleration or deceleration in the growth of population.

1) The growth of population was very low before 1921 due to prevalence of high birth rate and high death rate. The birth rate varied between 46 and 49 per thousand and death rate fluctuated between 42 and 48 per thousand.

Table 3.3: Average Annual Birth and Death Rates in India

Decade	Births per 1000	Deaths per 1000
1891-1900	45.8	44.4
1901-1910	48.1	42.6
1911-20	49.2	48.6
1921-30	46.4	36.3
1931-40	45.2	31.2
1941-50	39.9	27.4
1951-60	40.0	18.0
1961-70	41.2	19.2
1971-80	37.2	15.0
1985-86	32.6	11.1
2010-11	21.8	7.1

Source: Census of India, 1971, Age and Life Tables and Census of India 1981, Series I, Paper 1 of 1984 and Office of Register General and Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Annual Report (2000-01) and Economic Survey (2009-10)

2) After 1921 the gap between birth rate and death rate widened. There was fall in the death rate from 48.6 per thousand in 1911-20 to 7.1 per thousand in 2001-2010.

3) The birth rate also showed a decline after 1971 due to family planning programs. States like Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh, West Bengal, Karnataka and Punjab achieved a birth rate below 20 per thousand. But states like Haryana, Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Bihar, Madhya Pradesh had high birth rates ranging from 27-28 per thousand. Hence India as a whole did not enter third stage of demographic transition.

4) The high growth rate of population in India is an outcome of consistently high birth rate but relatively fast declining death rate.

3.3.3 Gender Composition of the Population

Gender ratio is a perfect way to find the number of women in any country. Gender ratio shows ratio of females to that of males in India. According to Census 2011, there were 940 females per 1000 males compared to 933 females per 1000 males in 2001. The imbalance in gender ratio in India has been persistent, showing a continuous declining trend since 1901, with the exception in 1981 and 2011, when it recorded a marginal improvement. It has been found that the probability of women to live longer than men is high. This is supported by evidence in the advanced western countries where the proportion of women in total population is higher than that of males. In India 108 females are born per 100 males but the loss of more females or problem of missing women as highlighted by Prof. Amartya Sen is due to reasons including the following:

1) Ignoring the nutrition needs of a girl child leading to higher mortality
2) High maternal mortality due to insufficient care and attention
3) Sex selection abortions due to social preference for a boy across communities
4) Female infanticide
5) Deterioration in the gender ratio at birth

Table 3.4: Gender Ratio in India

Year	Females per 1000 Males
1901	972
1911	964
1921	955
1931	950
1941	945
1951	946
1961	941
1971	930
1981	934
1991	927
2001	933
2011	940

As a consequence, in 2011 females per thousand males were 940, while in Russia it was (1,140), in Japan (1041) and in U.S.A (1029). The imbalance in gender